- Evolutionary algorithms provide us with more powerful tools for our toolkit. Based on biological evolution, we
    - Produce individuals
    - Select the best from the current generation
    - Shuffle the genes around
    - Mutate them to introduce some variation
    - Mate them to create new generations for the next population
- Evolutionary algorithms tend to be more data hungry and less data-efficient than gradient-based approaches; in some circumstances this may be fine, notably if you have a simulator.
- Evolutionary algorithms can optimize over nondifferentiable or even discrete functions, which gradient-based methods cannot do.
- Evolutionary strategies (ES) are a subclass of evolutionary algorithms that do not involve biological-like mating and recombination, but instead use copying with noise and weighted sums to create new individuals from a population.